

Nicholas Forster-Benson

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<https://nfb77.github.io/>

Education

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| 2025 - | Ph.D. Sociology & Social Policy, Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts |
| 2021 - 2025 | B.A. Economics; Quantitative Social Science, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, Tennessee
<i>magna cum laude</i> , highest honors (economics)
visiting student (graduate coursework), Università Bocconi, Milano, Lombardia |

Research Interests

Political economy	Organizational and economic sociology
Markets and inequality	Quantitative methods

Publications

- 2025 **N. Forster-Benson** and K. Nchare. "Upzoning and Residential Transaction Price in Nashville." *Journal of Housing Economics*, 70: 102104.

Works in Progress

N. Forster-Benson. "Corporate Ownership Density and Rent in the United States: An Analysis from 2012-2022." Working paper.

N. Forster-Benson. "Upzoning, Density, and the Financialization of Space in Nashville." Under Review.

N. Forster-Benson. "Towards a Relational Understanding of Zoning Conflict." In Preparation.

N. Forster-Benson and K. Nchare. "Trade Distortions and Colonial Legacy: Evidence from Portugal and Its Former Colonies." *Revise & Resubmit, Journal of International Development*.

Grants and Fellowships

External:

- 2026 Housing Case Studies Grant, Social Science Research Council (SSRC), Better Urbanism, Infrastructure, and Land-Use Decisions (BUILD) Program, with Karim Nchare, \$10,000

Internal:

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| 2026 | Graduate Seed Grant, Center for American Political Studies at Harvard University | \$1,000 |
| 2024 | John J. Siegfried Honors Economics Scholars Student Research Grant, | \$2,000 |
| 2023 | Humanities in the Real-World Fellow, Robert Penn Warren Center, | \$1,000 |
| 2023 | Vanderbilt Undergraduate Summer Research Program, | \$7,100 |

Teaching

Department of Economics, Vanderbilt University:

Fall 2024 Economic Statistics (ECON 1500), Teaching Assistant, [Syllabus](#)

Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt University:

Fall 2022, 2023 Contemporary American Society (SOC 3233), Teaching Assistant, [Syllabus](#)

Fall 2023 Cultural Production and Institutions (SOC 3202), Teaching Assistant, [Syllabus](#)

Research

2023 - 2025 Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Vanderbilt University

Advisor: Dr. Karim Nchare

2023 Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt University

Advisor: Dr. Richard Lloyd

2023 Research Assistant, Lab. for Research on Conflict and Collective Action

Advisor: Dr. Andrew Coe

Non-Academic Employment

2026 - Graduate Resident Advisor, Harvard Graduate School of Arts and Sciences

2022 - 2025 Resident Advisor, V. U. Office of Housing and Residential Experience

2024 Candidate, Tennessee State House District 56

2023 Intern, U.S. Federal Reserve Board

2022 Intern, Tennessee Department of Treasury

Affiliation

2025 - Graduate affiliate, Center for American Political Studies, Harvard University

2025 - Graduate affiliate, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University

2025 - Member, American Sociological Association

2023 - Member, American Planning Association

Programming Languages

L^AT_EX, Python, QGIS, R, Stata